

RASHAY DAYA

DEVOPS ENGINEER & FULL STACK BUILDER

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DevOps engineer on Sanlam Fintech's Platform Engineering team. I look after the shared Terraform estate ten product teams build on, keep the security scanning and release tooling running, and pick up production incidents when they land. The part of the job I like most is when something I built gets used without me noticing; outside work I ship full-stack platforms for real clients and maintain open-source DevOps tooling under Kaji Labs.

BSc Computer Science, Wits (Dean's List) · IITPSA member · Golden Key International Honour Society

FinLead Award winner December 2025, Innovation (Jugaad)

Sanlam Fintech's award for living the Leadership Principles through 2025, won in my first year. Cited for finding a way where others saw a blocker: the stack naming pattern that made sandbox deploys safe, an Excel-driven E2E test generator anyone can use, the first AI Terraform Skills (first versions 2025, v1.0.0 September 2026), and a state-unlock pipeline that stopped teams hand-editing Terraform state.

> EXPERIENCE

Junior DevOps Engineer · Platform Engineering, Sanlam Fintech Jul 2025 – present

- Own the shared Terraform estate ten product teams build on: grew it from **26 to 58 modules** (the most-used one has **37 dependent repos**) and built the module index, versioning and release tooling it runs on.
- Wrote the RDS, ALB/WAF and Fargate modules, then combined them into the blueprint that stood up an internal hiring application end to end.
- Run estate-wide upgrade sweeps that keep all **55+ repos** on the latest tooling; the largest updated every repo in a single day.
- Published the scaffold template that lets any org bootstrap GitHub OIDC roles instead of hand-rolling trust policies.
- Co-built the Platform Engineering security tooling dashboard: one SBOM view across **17 GitHub organisations**.
- Made IaC and container security scanning a required standard, enforced by a daily compliance Lambda, with per-team Slack reporting. Drove remediation of **900+ findings** with one team.
- Created the AI Terraform Skills that audit every module against Sanlam Fintech standards and draw its architecture diagram; **v1.0.0** shipped September 2026.
- Resolved **6 production incidents** on-call, including same-day credential rotation on a payments API.
- Organised and co-presented the 2026 DevOps Community of Practice session (**19 attendees**) and coached engineers across four teams, one from clickops to running his own Terraform deploys.

Graduate · Sanlam Data & Digital Academy (SDDA), Sanlam Group Technology (SGT) Jan 2024 – Jun 2025

- Final placement, Sanlam Fintech Platform Engineering (2025): co-developed the first **26 reusable Terraform modules**, 2 blueprints, 2 scaffold templates and a reusable AWS IAM policy library. This estate carried Digisure's migration to pre-production and MultiPay Collections to production.
- Co-created the complete stack naming pattern (stack, project, version, developer) so developers deploy isolated sandbox stacks without colliding with shared resources. Introduced DR tagging across the modules.
- Put Digisure's API Swagger docs onto Cloudflare Pages so they rebuild on every deploy, and started an Excel-driven E2E test generator for a product team so non-technical users can write and verify tests.
- Co-presented at the DevOps Community of Practice (2025) on reusable modules and the Units of Deployment strategy: splitting mono-repos into per-service repositories, which Digisure then adopted.
- Rotations: MS Chapter (full-stack on an adviser-facing policy app, React TypeScript, Redux, C#); SGT DBA (backups, alert automation, SAP Hana, SQL Server, MariaDB, PowerShell); SGT Solution Architecture (GitHub Actions research, conceptual and logical diagrams for an internal platform).

Technical Test Analyst · FNB, POP IT Quality Assurance Jul – Dec 2023

- Wrote and ran automated test cases in Java and Appium for FNB's new Enterprise Telling System.

> EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science & Computational Applications · University of the Witwatersrand 2020 – 2022

- Majors in Computer Science and Computational Applications. Dean's List 2021.
- Systems: Software Design, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Parallel Computing, Computer Graphics, Advanced Algorithms, Formal Languages, Mobile Computing.
- Maths and data: Machine Learning, Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus, Mathematical Statistics, Abstract Mathematics.

> PROJECTS, SHIPPED

Event RSVP & media platform

marrying-maharaj.co.za

Live full-stack platform with guest validation, RSVP flows and media uploads; **200+ guest records**.

REACT · FIREBASE · CLOUDFLARE R2 · NODE.JS

The House of Chai

thehouseofchai.co.za

Production web platform for a hospitality brand, built and deployed end to end and live for customers.

REACT · NODE.JS · CLOUDFLARE PAGES · RAILWAY

PR Version Bot (Kaji Labs, open source)

github.com/kaji-labs/pr-version-bot

GitHub Action that bumps semver, updates the changelog, tags and publishes a release from a single label on a merged PR.

GITHUB ACTIONS · BASH · SEMVER

Sanlam Platinum Plus

Web-based insurance policy management system for luxury and high-value items: user registration, policy and claim management.

PYTHON · FLASK · JINJA · SQL SERVER · HTML · CSS

AI marketing hackathon (Sanlam, 2024)

Turned an existing email marketing flow into personalised WhatsApp messages.

PYTHON · REACT · OPENAI API

Earlier work (2019–2022) - Zen Marker and Swap Shop Android apps (Java, MySQL, Firebase); Student Support website (React); ZOMARCHY 3D shooter (Three.js); online grocery app (Delphi). All on github.com/Rashay01.

> SKILLS

Cloud & infra: AWS (Lambda, CloudFront, S3, ECS Fargate, RDS, WAF, Cognito), Terraform, Cloudflare, Docker, Linux, Railway

CI/CD & security: GitHub Actions, composite actions, Bash, PowerShell, Trivy, Gitleaks, GHAS, SBOM, OIDC, semantic versioning

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C#, C, C++, SQL, HCL, Delphi, HTML, CSS

Web: React, Next.js, Node.js, REST APIs, Tailwind, Three.js, Flask

Databases: Firebase, MySQL, SQL Server, SAP Hana, MariaDB, MS Access

AI tooling: Claude Code skills and agents, MCP, OpenAI API, AI-driven IaC auditing

Tools: Datadog, CloudWatch, Slack workflows, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Codecov, Git, Android Studio, Visual Studio

Strengths: Problem solving, mathematics, data analysis, technical writing, communication, leadership, teamwork

> AWARDS AND HONOURS

- FinLead Award for Innovation (Jugaad), Sanlam Fintech, December 2025
- Sanlam Data & Digital Academy award for completing the academy, January 2025
- Dean's List, University of the Witwatersrand, 2021
- Golden Key International Honour Society, top 15% of achievers, 2021

> COMMUNITIES

- Member, Institute of Information Technology Professionals of South Africa (IITPSA)
- Member, Golden Key International Honour Society
- Presenter, Sanlam Fintech DevOps Community of Practice, 2025 and 2026
- Founder and maintainer, Kaji Labs open-source DevOps tooling (PR Version Bot and more)
- Community service: taught maths and arts & crafts to learners, 2018–19

> SDDA TRAINING MODULES

Cloud on AWS · DevOps using AWS and Jenkins · Python · Databases · JavaScript and React · Machine Learning and AI · Business and Process Analysis · Consumer Experience (CX) · Enterprise Architecture · Agile Fundamentals · Presentation Skills

> CERTIFICATIONS

- Selenium 4 WebDriver with Java (Basics, Advanced, Architect), Udemy
- Foundational C# with Microsoft, freeCodeCamp
- Discovering Ethical AI, Udacity
- Get the Most out of Confluence, Atlassian University
- Sage Pastel Accounting certificate, 2019
- First Aid course certificate, 2018

> OFF THE CLOCK

Before the terminal there was a mixing desk: three years cutting music for dance competitions is where the habit of getting the timing exactly right comes from. I played first-team hockey, taught maths to younger learners on weekends, and still like explaining things more than I probably should, which is how I ended up presenting at the CoP twice. Data science and machine learning are what I read for fun, side projects occasionally turn into real client sites, and I speak English and Afrikaans. Still can't leave a repo without a README.